

QUALITIES AND ROLE OF A MATHEMATICS TEACHER

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Introduction:

The success of the learning process is determined by the role of an instructor. Instructors (the teachers/lecturers) bring their own power in the classroom. Mathematics teachers are all the time hard pressed to make the subject an interesting and appealing one for their learners at the secondary and senior secondary level, the intricacies of mathematics begins to get more and more complex and the mathematics teachers find it increasingly difficult to retain the interest of the learners in the subject.

Teacher effectiveness may also be considered in regards to student expectations in the classroom. Martin and Rimm-Kaufman (2015) emphasize that ideal math learning is not a passive process of memorizing and using standard algorithms, instead students engage in reasoning, problem solving, and discourse with teachers and other students to explore mathematical problems.

Professional qualities of a mathematics teacher:

Interest in mathematics- A mathematics teacher should have full command over subject matter. It is possible when he has interest in mathematics

Positive attitude towards mathematics- A mathematics teacher should have positive attitude towards his teaching subject. Because his self-attitude directly influences the learning process of the students.

Knowledge of subject matter- A mathematics teacher should have full knowledge of his subject. A little knowledge in subject matter cannot make him trustworthy among students

Knowledge of individual differences- A good teacher is he who has the knowledge to judge individual differences because every student is different in reading, writing, understanding and work speed in mathematics.

Knowledge of different teaching methods- With a firm grip over the subject matter, a mathematics teacher should know the teaching methods. He should clearly know the aims and objectives of mathematics.

Power to know the difficulties of the students- It is very necessary for a mathematics teacher to know where the students are feeling difficulty in solving problems.

Presentation of subject matter- A teacher should present the subject matter skillfully making interaction with the students, introducing well methods and applying various aids

Inspiration to drill work- A mathematics teacher should inspire and motivate the students to drill and practice work through examples understand the basic concept of formulae.

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Characteristics of Good Mathematics Teacher:

On-Time: Arriving at school or entering to the class on time is considered as the most important criteria of good lecturers. On time is important to ensure a conducive learning atmosphere and create efficient and effective learning process in the classroom.

Objective: Objective is the second prominent characteristic of good mathematics teachers. Objective lecturers motivate students to study harder. Objectiveness also encourages students to compete objectively.

Mastering the subject matter: Based on the lecturers' perspective, mastering the subject matters has been the most prominent characteristic of good mathematics lecturers. The lecturers state that when the teachers/lecturers do not master the material, the learning process does not run well and the students do not pay attention to what they teach.

Delivering the subject matters clearly: this is also related to another characteristic of good math teacher. During the learning process, the lecturer needs to consider the degree of readiness and students' interest.

Giving motivation to the students: Motivating students to learn mathematics is another characteristic of good math lecturer. Students wish some motivation from the lecturers/teachers in every learning process. The motivation can be encouraging students to be enthusiastic in learning. It also could be providing some objectives of the study in each meeting.

Professional: Professional attitude in this case is defined as an attitude of doing jobs as well as possible and having high competence. Professional lecturers are capable of doing a good job.

Professional development programmes for mathematics teachers are designed to be comprehensive and rigorous, equipping the teachers with a wide- ranging set of pedagogical skills to become more effective in their classrooms. Organizing and participating in such professional development programmes help the teachers in the following ways:

- Become more attune to the latest developments in the field of mathematics,
- Develop greater commitment towards their learners,
- Create a platform for sharing professional experiences,
- Work towards continuous improvement of their teaching skills,

- Keep abreast of skills required to adapt to ever- changing learners curriculum,
- Tailoring their teaching content according to the needs of their learners,
- Acquiring knowledge and skills for integrating technology into everyday teaching practices,
- To develop the knowledge and skills which they need to address learners' learning challenges more effectively,
- Integrate the latest research findings and teaching models to achieve better learning outcomes,
- Apply action research findings in diverse classrooms.

Thanking You...